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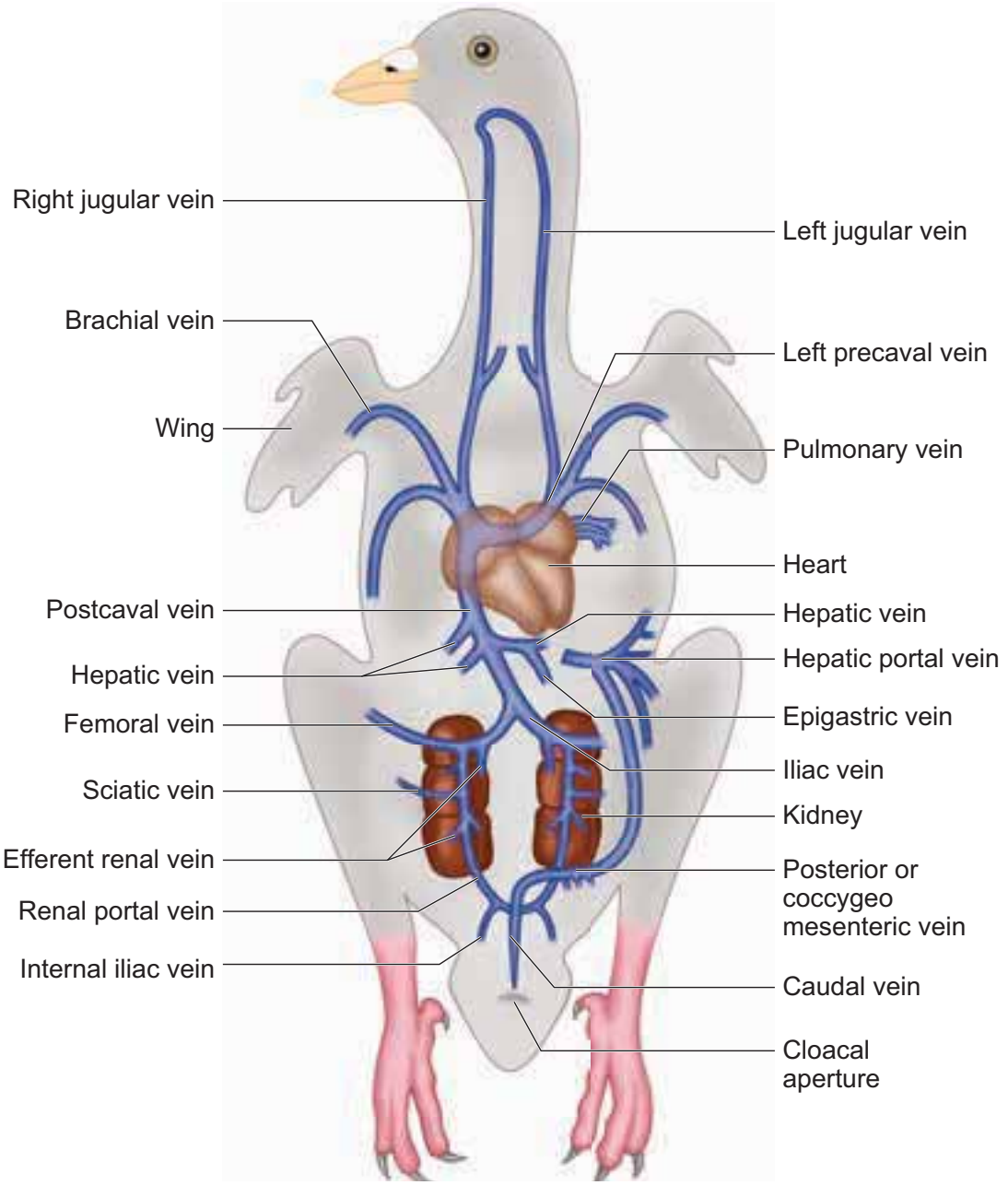


Figure 4.33 Pigeon – Venous System

the liver is emptied into the postcaval vein by three **hepatic veins.** (Figure 4.33)

The **caudal vein** from the tail divides into the right and the left renal-portal vein each of which enters the kidney. Before entry, the renal-portal vein is joined by the **internal iliac vein** from the pelvis. As the **renal-portal vein** passes through the kidney, it receives the sciatic and the femoral vein from the leg, and finally emerges from the kidneys as the iliac vein. The renal-portal veins do not break into capillaries in the kidney but only send a few small branches; renal-portal circulation is therefore not well developed in the bird.

At the place of bifurcation of the caudal vein into the two renal-portal veins arises the median **coccygeomesenteric vein** which is characteristic of birds.